B2 - Written Mediation 1: Task

Gender-inclusive language



INCLUSIVE LANGUAGE

(Gender-neutral language is a generic term covering the use of non-sexist language. The purpose of gender-neutral language is to avoid word choices which may be interpreted as biased, discriminatory or demeaning by implying that one sex or social gender is the norm. Using gender-fair and inclusive language also helps reduce gender stereotyping, promotes social change and contributes to archieving gender equality.
(European Parliament, 2018)

Keep it neutral

- Address people by their name instead of "Mr." or "Ms."
- Say "Excuse me" instead of "Sir" or "Madam".
- Avoid common masculine addressing phrases such as "Hey guys". Use "Hey everyone".

Don't assume

Always ask. Don't make assumptions based on appearances or how people sound when d**eciding the pronoun to use. A simple** "What are your pronouns?" works perfectly.

Avoid "he", "his", etc.

Use "he" or "she" sparingly and only when strictly necessary. Instead

- Use plural forms.
- Use the imperative.
- Omit the pronoun altogether.
- Use passive.

Use unbiased generic words

Avoid the generic use of "man". Use its derivates such as "humankind" instead of "mankind".
Use gender-neutral job titles such as firefighter" instead of "fireman". Use generic words such as "siblings", "parents", "partner", etc.

Inclusive content

Bear in mind that other realities apart from yours are possible. There are all sorts of families, people with disabilities, sexual orientations, gender identities and ethnicities, among other situations. Be careful when talking about certain topics and beware of the words you choose.

Your Australian friend, Aaron, has been using language that may be considered sexist by many people. He is not conscious of the evolution of language use and how gender-inclusive language must be incorporated into our ordinary speech.

Write a text message to your friend (about 80 words) giving him advice on how to use more inclusive language.



In written mediation, you need to interpret the content of the infographic, and be able to explain and give your opinion, if asked, in an informal or colloquial way.

Make sure you include all the aspects your friend needs to know in your message.
A text message does not have a clear structure, but it normally has one paragraph.